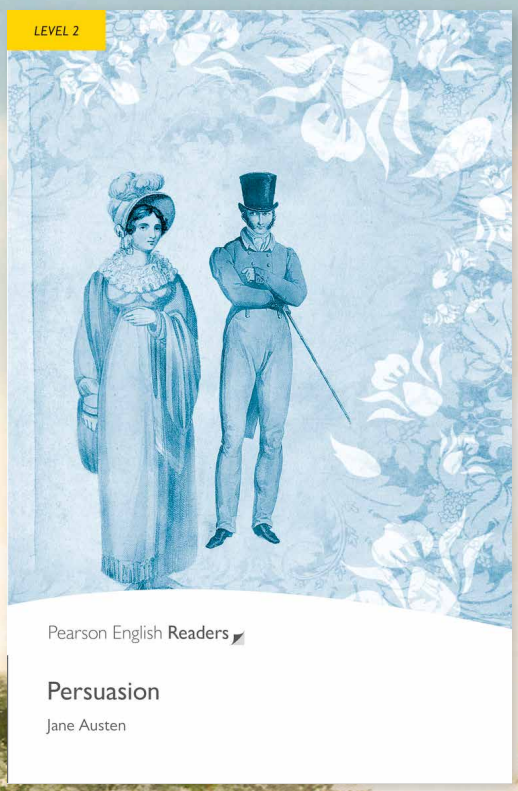
PERSUASION by Jane Austen (A2–A2+)



PREPARATION

1 **Look at the pictures and answer the questions.**



see

1 What do these rings mean?
2 What are they usually made of?

think

3 Who do you think should decide if someone can marry the person they love?
4 What is a good age to marry?
5 What are the positives and negatives of marrying someone?

wonder

6 Are married people happier than unmarried people?
7 What happens if someone can't marry the person they want to marry?
8 What are the reasons that people get married?

WILL YOU MARRY ME?

'Your daughter, Anne, and I are in love, sir,' Captain Wentworth said. 'We are very happy together. I am here **to ask you**, Sir Walter, **for your daughter's hand**. We want to marry.'

Sir Walter did not say 'yes' or 'no'. He was cold and unfriendly to Captain Wentworth and he was not interested in his daughter, Anne. He did not want to help her to marry the young man she loved. He did not want her to be happy.

Lady Russell wanted Anne to be happy but she too did not want Anne to marry Captain Wentworth – she thought Anne was too young. Anne was only nineteen. And Captain Wentworth had no money. She wanted Anne to wait and find a richer, more important man to marry, not a young officer in **the navy**. Anne listened carefully to Lady Russell. The older woman's **persuasion** slowly began to work. Slowly, Anne started to think her love for Captain Wentworth was wrong.

'Perhaps I am too young,' she thought. 'And perhaps I cannot help Frederick to be happy. I must think of his work in the navy – perhaps he can do better without me. Perhaps Lady Russell is right – I know she loves me and is my friend.'

She saw Captain Wentworth one last time. Her face was very sad. 'I am very sorry, Captain Wentworth,' she said to him, 'but I cannot marry you.'

'But we are happy together, Miss Elliot!' he answered. 'I do not understand this. Why … ?'

'I cannot say,' Anne answered, 'but that is my last word. We cannot marry.'

Captain Wentworth left that afternoon, and soon he left the country. He went to sea again in his ship.

Anne changed. She was quieter and her pretty face was often sad. She loved Captain Wentworth. But she was not going to marry him, so now she did not want to marry anybody.

GLOSSARY

to ask for someone's hand *v.* to ask permission to marry someone
the navy *n.* people and ships a country has for fighting wars at sea
persuasion *n.* trying to make someone decide to do something



COMPREHENSION

2 LL4.01 **Listen and read the text. Complete sentences 1–10 with the names in the box.**
You can use the names more than once.

Captain Wentworth (CW)	Lady Russell (LR)
Anne Elliot (AE)	Sir Walter (SW)

1 ..... asks Anne's father an important question.
2 ..... does not act kindly.
3 ..... wants the best for Anne.
4 ..... does not have much money.
5 ..... persuades Anne to think again.
6 ..... thinks Captain Wentworth's job is important.
7 ..... makes a big decision.
8 ..... says no to marrying.
9 ..... does not give a reason.
10 ..... returns to sea.

ACTIVE INVESTIGATION

3 **There are many classic romance stories where two people can't be together. Choose one or two of the stories in the box and answer the questions.**

1 Find a synopsis of the story on the internet. Why can't the two people be together?
2 Is there a happy ending for them in the story?

Romeo and Juliet
Antonio Corelli and Pelagia in *Captain Corelli's Mandolin*
Heathcliff and Cathy in *Wuthering Heights*
Rose and Jack in *Titanic*
Bella and Edward in *Twilight*

SPEAKING

4 **Tell the class about the story you have chosen. As a class, decide which story is the most romantic.**

CLIL CONNECTION

Geography

5A **Choose ten different countries. Guess what the average age is that people marry. Make sure you choose countries in different parts of the world, e.g. The Americas, Europe, Asia.**

B **Find out the average age people get married in the countries you have chosen.**

C **Is your answer different from your answer in Ex 1 Question 4. What do you think about that question now?**